

TOWN OF PERU

Selectboard Meeting

March 15, 2023

Present: Jon Mowry, Alex Sheets, Barbara Petra, Jim Potter, Melinda Beebe.

Meeting Called to Order: Jon called the meeting to order at 6:37pm. Jon welcomed our new Selectboard Member, Alex Sheets, to his first meeting.

Review/Approve Minutes: The March 1st meeting was canceled due to the lack of a quorum.

Request to Change Agenda: None

Public Comment: None

Road Foreman Report: No Road Forman report. Wayne is getting some much deserved rest after the huge snowstorm and a rough couple of days.

New Business:

Appoint Town Officers as needed: Alex nominates Jon Mowry, Jon seconded. All in favor. Jon motioned we reappoint all previous boards to include:

<u>Planning Commission</u>	<u>Term Expires</u>	<u>Zoning Board</u>	<u>Term Expires</u>
Andy Dahlstrom	2026	Chuck Black	2026
Jim Jordan	2026	Peter Bradford	2024
LJ Petra	2024	Charles Howard	2025
Mike Gayda	2024	David Utiger	2025
Lucas Hughes	2025		
Vacant	2025		

Zoning Administrator: William Goodwin

Sexton: Carl Holcomb

Town Service Officer: Melissa O'Brien

Health Officer: Mike Gayda

Deputy Health Officer: Josh Witkin

Road Commissioner: Todd Williams

Emergency Manager: Chuck Black and Todd Williams

Alex seconded. All in favor. Motion passed.

Designate Posting locations for public notices: Jon made the motion to have all Warnings, Agendas & Minutes posted inside and outside at the Town Office. They will also be posted at the Post Office and on the Peru Town Website. Alex seconded. Motion passed.

Set time for Selectboard Meetings: Jon moves that selectboard meetings take place at 6:30pm the first and third Wednesday of the month. Alex seconded. Motion passed.

Pay Rate for Town Treasurer: Jon motions we continue to pay Donna Williams what she is making now for as long as she is training the new treasurer. Alex seconded. Motion passed. Alex motions that the new treasurer, Cheryl Fox, be paid \$20.00 per hour. Jon seconded. Motion passed.

Discussion on Donna continuing until such time that the new treasurer, Cheryl Fox, is ready to be on her own.

Feasibility Study for changes to Hapgood Pond Rd and Main Street Intersection: Discussion on using ARPA funds to reroute where Hapgood Road meets Main Street, making it a true 90 degree turn. We would have to hire a firm to do the feasibility study and then go from there. Engineers would be needed for the actual project. Barbara Petra inquired what else could be done to slow people down. Jim Potter spoke about installing solar signs that flash at both intersections. Installing crosswalks and reverse speed bumps were also discussed. Jon stated that it would be possible to roll these ideas into the feasibility study. Jon made a motion to earmark, not more than, \$5000.00 for said feasibility study. Alex seconded. Motion passed.

Proposal for work on Town Center: This is a proposal about upgrading the downstairs of the Town Center to house the Town Archives that are now located upstairs in the Old Creamery. Discussion was tabled until the next meeting.

Sharing a Town Zoning Administrator: Jon Spoke of having a conversation with Will Goodwin about the possibility of sharing a Zoning Administrator much like the Mountain Towns will be sharing a Recreation Director. All surrounding towns would contract with one person to serve. Concerns were raised as to how the time would be divided fairly among the towns. Jon stated that this is a very early discussion and many details would have to be addressed.

Town Forest Updates: The County Forester inquired whether the Town of Peru wants its forest boundaries painting and if we want to be enrolled in the American Tree Farm Program. Jon Motioned that the town take advantage of both offerings. Alex seconded. Motion passed.

Next steps on Short Term Rental Ordinance: STRO will take affect. 60 days from the time it was passed by the selectboard, April 15, 2023. Landlords need to register with the town within 90 days after that time. Many details need to be worked out for this ordinance to be implemented. The process is continuing to get these details worked out.

Old Business: None

Other Business: Jon motions that the board approve three overweight permits: Chave's Construction, Cardinal Logistics & rk Miles. Alex seconded. Motion passed.

Review Bills/Approve Payments: All bills were approved for payment.

Adjournment: Jon moved we adjourn at 7:41 pm, Alex seconded. Motion passed.

Respectfully Submitted,
Melinda M. Beebe
Town Clerk
Peru, VT

Legislative Update December 11 2024

The North Carolina House reconvened today (December 11) for its final session of the year, focusing primarily on overriding Governor Roy Cooper's veto of Senate Bill 382, Disaster Relief-3/Budget/Various Law Changes. The Senate met on December 2 and voted to override the Governor's veto along party lines. Senate Bill 382 contained some disaster relief provisions, but also restructured elements of state government and included various other provisions. A more detailed summary of Senate Bill 382 is below.

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During the initial vote on the bill, three Republicans from Western North Carolina opposed the bill. There was much speculation about whether these three Republicans would vote to override—for without all three votes, the Republicans may not have the 72 votes they need to override the veto. Ultimately the three House Republicans voted to override the veto, and the veto was overridden by a vote of 72-46, along party lines. Senate Bill 382 is now law.

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In addition to the veto override, the House passed a constitutional amendment to require voter ID for in-person voting and for absentee ballots submitted by mail. This constitutional amendment will appear on the November 2026 ballot.

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With the close of today's legislative session, the House and Senate are officially adjourned for 2024. The General Assembly will reconvene on January 8 to swear in new legislators for the new biennium; and will be back in late January to start the long session. Without a Republican veto-proof supermajority in 2025, the dynamics between the General Assembly and incoming Governor-Elect Josh Stein could shift significantly, influencing the legislative agenda and the state's political landscape moving forward.

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Senate Bill 382, Disaster Relief-3/Budget/Various Law Changes, addressing disaster relief for Western North Carolina, technical budget adjustments, modifications to appointment powers and other powers of the executive branch, and various other technical and substantive law changes. The bill contains the following provisions:-

- Transfers \$227 million from the Savings Reserve to the Helene Fund for hurricane relief efforts.
- Allocates \$33.75 million to continue the compensation grants portion of the Child Care Stabilization Grants, providing a third quarter of reduced funding.
- Transfer the State Board of Elections from an independent agency under the Governor to the Department of the State Auditor. While the State Auditor will oversee the Board's budget, they will not direct its management functions. The Auditor will assume responsibility for appointing members of the State Board and county board chairs. Key implementation milestones include:
 - New State Board appointed in May 2025.
 - New county boards and chairs appointed in June 2025.
 - Budget oversight transferred to the Auditor starting with the 2025-26 fiscal year.
- Modifies the Governor's appointment process and clarifies the Senate's authority of advice and consent regarding appointments
- Requires the Governor to fill Supreme Court and Court of Appeals vacancies from a list of three recommendations provided by the political party of the vacating judge or justice at the time of their election.
- Removes the Attorney General's authority to intervene in matters before the NC Utilities Commission and clarifies that the Judicial Department and Council of State agencies are not required to seek approval from the Attorney General or the Governor to retain private counsel.
- Establishes the State Highway Patrol (SHP) as an independent, cabinet-level department, and transfers the State Capital Police and the License and Theft Bureau within the Division of Motor Vehicles to this new department. ALE is not transferred to this new agency.
 - Eliminates one Governor-appointed seat on the NC Utilities Commission and assigns this appointment to the State Treasurer; and requires the Chair of the Utilities Commission to be elected by a vote of the Commission members (was; designated by the Governor)
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